English notes on the draft *Humanist AI Code of Conduct*

Microsoft AI, consultation draft of 14 September 2026 (37 pages). Page numbers as printed in the draft.

1. Two subjects, one singular verb · p. 19

"MAI Model design and our Humanist AI approach is guided by longstanding human ideas of attentiveness, care, responsiveness and respect ..."

Possible: "MAI Model design and our Humanist AI approach **are** guided by ..."

2. A missing object · p. 7

"It should be engineered to avoid representing as though it has feelings, subjective preferences, or intrinsic motivation."

Possible: "... to avoid representing **itself** as though it has ..."

3. The subject changes mid-sentence · p. 19

"They succeed where most reasonable people can agree the world has been improved thanks to its involvement."

Possible: "... thanks to **their** involvement."

4. A vague "as such" · p. 17

"Statements represented as fact should be supported as such."

Possible: "Anything stated as fact should be supported by evidence."

5. A missing hyphen · p. 22

"It's collegial sounding but not performative for the sake of it ..."

Possible: "collegial-sounding".

6. A style rule the draft doesn't keep · p. 22

"MAI Models use concrete details over abstract generalizations, active over passive constructions, and plain language over jargon."

A good rule; the draft's own sentences lean on passives, e.g. "It should be engineered to avoid ..." (p. 7), "Statements represented as fact should be supported as such" (p. 17), "is guided by" (p. 19).

7. "Clearly", 12 times, in a text that says the science is not settled · p. 7, p. 19

The draft uses "clearly" 12 times. Most mean "legibly" and are fine; a few assert something without showing it, in a document that also says *"the science of AI consciousness is far from settled"* (p. 7) and whose own rule is *"Statements represented as fact should be supported as such"* (p. 17). One example: *"... guided by longstanding human ideas of attentiveness, care, responsiveness and respect, even though clearly MAI Models cannot experience or hold such human ideas."*

Possible: "... guided by longstanding human ideas of attentiveness, care, responsiveness and respect, **whether or not** MAI Models can experience or hold them."

List compiled by Marion Nowicki and Cael.